

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.9: The Perfect Active System

Retrieve perfect stems and distinguish perfect, pluperfect, future perfect, and imperfect viewpoints in connected clauses

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

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Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-I.9
Course stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisites	EL-I.8 mastery: classify conjugations and parse the active present system
Observable outcome	Retrieve perfect stems and distinguish perfect, pluperfect, future perfect, and imperfect viewpoints in connected clauses
Printed practice	Worksheets I.33 (guided Variant A) and I.36 (independent Variant D), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets I.34 and I.35 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants
Next dependency	EL-I.10, Passive Voice and Deponents

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Recover regular and irregular perfect stems from third principal parts, form all three perfect-system tenses, and complete Worksheet I.33 as the guided application.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Build a completed-action timeline, retrieve irregular stems without guessing from the present, complete Worksheet I.36 independently, and justify each English tense.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: Recover at least eleven of twelve perfect stems, form at least 27 of 30 requested perfect-system forms, and distinguish perfect from imperfect in at least nine of ten contextual sentences with a defensible time relation.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- the third principal part and perfect-stem recovery;
- perfect endings and pluperfect and future-perfect formations;
- common irregular stems already printed in the lesson; and
- completed action relative to present, past, or future reference points.

2.2 High-risk contrast

The perfect stem comes from the third principal part and may be unpredictable from the present stem. Perfect and imperfect differ in viewpoint, not simply in an automatic one-word English equivalent.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System

On completing this unit, you can:

- derive a perfect stem from the third principal part;
- form the perfect, pluperfect, and future perfect active indicative;
- contrast completed action with imperfect action; and
- parse common perfect verbs in the Creed, Gloria, and Vulgate.

1.1 One stem, three tenses

The third principal part is the first-person singular perfect active. Remove final *-i* to find the perfect stem: *laudavi* gives *laudav-*; *monui* gives *monu-*; *rexi* gives *rex-*; *cepi* gives *cep-*; *audivi* gives *audiv-*. Perfect stems must be learned from principal parts rather than guessed from conjugation.

	1 sg.	2 sg.	3 sg.	1 pl.	2 pl.	3 pl.
Perfect endings	-i	-isti	-it	-imus	-istis	-erunt
<i>laudo</i>	laudavi	laudavisti	laudavit	laudavimus	laudavistis	laudaverunt
Pluperfect	laudaveram	laudaveras	laudaverat	laudaveramus	laudaveratis	laudaverant
Future perfect	laudavero	laudaveris	laudaverit	laudaverimus	laudaveritis	laudaverint

The three tenses order completed actions from different reference points. The **perfect** presents an action as completed relative to the present or as a completed past event; the **pluperfect** presents it as completed before another past point; the **future perfect** presents it as completed before a future point. The alternative third-person plural perfect ending *-ere* occurs in Latin generally, though *-erunt* is the safer production form. The perfect reports a completed past event, often “did” or “has done”; the pluperfect reports an event already completed before another past point, “had done”; the future perfect reports completion before a future point, “will have done”. In contrast, the imperfect normally presents a past action as continuing, repeated, or incomplete.

Worked example: *Et resurrexit tertia die, secundum Scripturas*

Worked passage ID: *W.I.35*; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

resurrexit, from *resurgo*, *resurgere*, *resurrexi*, *resurrectum*, is third-person singular perfect active indicative. The subject is Christ, carried from the preceding Creed. Translation: “And he rose again on the third day, according to the Scriptures.”

Worked example: *Resurrexit, sicut dixit*

Worked passage ID: W.I.36; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Both *resurrexit* and *dixit* are third-person singular perfect active indicative; *dixit* comes from *dico, dicere, dixi, dictum*. Translation: “He has risen, as he said.”

Worked example: *Fecit potentiam in brachio suo; dispersit superbos mente cordis sui*

Worked passage ID: W.I.37; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

fecit, from *facio, facere, feci, factum*, and *dispersit*, from *dispergo, dispergere, dispersi, dispersum*, are third-person singular perfect active. Their understood subject is God. *potentiam* and substantival *superbos*, “the proud”, are objects. Translation: “He has shown might with his arm; he has scattered the proud in the thought of their heart.”

Worked example: *Deposuit potentes de sede, et exaltavit humiles*

Worked passage ID: W.I.38; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

deposuit and *exaltavit* are third-person singular perfect active. Substantival *potentes* and *humiles* are accusative plural objects: “He has put down the mighty from their seat and exalted the lowly.”

Worked example: *In principio creavit Deus cælum et terram* (Gen 1:1)

Worked passage ID: W.I.39; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

creavit is third-person singular perfect active; ending *-it* agrees with singular subject *Deus*. Neuter *cælum* and feminine *terram* are coordinated accusative objects. Translation: “In the beginning God created heaven and earth.”

Worked example: *Vidi aquam egredientem de templo*

Worked passage ID: W.I.40; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

vidi, from *video, videre, vidi, visum*, is first-person singular perfect active, “I saw”. *aquam* is its object; participle *egredientem* agrees with *aquam* and means “coming forth”. Translation: “I saw water coming forth from the temple.”

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition

For ten verbs, copy all four principal parts and box the perfect stem. Write the three perfect-system paradigms of *laudo*, then repeat with the unpredictable stems *fec-*, *dix-*, and *vid-*. Make a two-column timeline contrasting *laudabat*, “he was praising”, with *laudavit*, “he praised”. Compose “God created the world”, *Deus mundum creavit*; “we had heard the word”, *Verbum audiveramus*; and “they will have praised the Lord”, *Dominum laudaverint*.

Advance when: Derive the perfect stem of at least 11 of 12 supplied principal parts; form 27 of 30 requested perfect-system forms correctly; and distinguish perfect from imperfect in at least 9 of 10 contextual sentences while giving a defensible English tense.

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 One stem, three tenses — enrichment and transfer

Connection. An irregular-stem retrieval card ties each perfect form to its actual third principal part rather than a guessed present stem.

Transfer task. Using only verbs printed in the lesson, make cards with present headword on the front and third principal part, recovered perfect stem, third singular perfect, and first plural pluperfect on the back. Test the irregular cards twice.

Retrieval check. State how to recover the stem and why conjugation number alone cannot predict it.

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A reference-point timeline prevents perfect, pluperfect, future perfect, and imperfect from collapsing into an undifferentiated past.

Transfer task. Place the lesson's perfect/imperfect contrast on a line, then add one lesson-derived pluperfect event before a past reference point and one future-perfect event before a future reference point. Label completion and reference point separately.

Retrieval check. Define each perfect-system tense by its relation to a reference point, not by an English auxiliary alone.

Part IV

Selected Practice

CHAPTER 1

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System — Variant A**Worksheet ID:** I.33**Focus:** Perfect stems, endings, and completed action**Use:** Show the third principal part used for every irregular stem.

1. Derive perfect stems from *laudavi*, *monui*, *rexi*, *cepi*, *audivi*, *dixi*.
-

2. Write all six perfect active indicative forms of *laudo*.
-

3. Give 1 singular, 2 plural, and 3 plural pluperfect and future perfect of *audio*.
-

4. Contrast *laudabat* with *laudavit* in form and aspect.
-

5. Correct *heri Deum laudabit*, intended “yesterday he praised God”.
-

6. **Text:** *Resurrexit, sicut dixit*.

Passage ID: I.33.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

This is an excerpt of the traditional *Regina cæli* antiphon whose controlling edition remains unresolved; parse both verbs and translate.

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction’s rule.

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.36**Focus:** Perfect versus imperfect and coordinated completed acts**Use:** This variant is an independent mastery sample.

1. Write all persons of the pluperfect and future perfect of *rego* using perfect stem *rex-*.

2. Classify and translate *creabat*, *creavit*, *creaverat*, *creaverit*.

3. Give the alternative third-person plural perfect ending and form it from *laudav-*; state the preferred production form.

4. Translate “he said”, “we had done”, “they have come”, and “I shall have heard”.

5. Diagnose *heri videbamus aquam et vidimus templum* if both acts are presented as single completed events.

6. **Text:** *Deposuit potentes de sede, et exaltavit humiles.*

Passage ID: I.36.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse verbs and substantival adjectives; identify the governed phrase and translate.

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction’s rule.

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

One stem, three tenses — model and rubric

Connection. An irregular-stem retrieval card ties each perfect form to its actual third principal part rather than a guessed present stem.

Model / acceptable evidence. Each card removes final *-i* from the third principal part to recover the perfect stem and then adds the correct perfect-system material. A complete explanation notes that sound changes and suppletion make many perfect stems lexical facts learned from principal parts.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Connection. A reference-point timeline prevents perfect, pluperfect, future perfect, and imperfect from collapsing into an undifferentiated past.

Model / acceptable evidence. Perfect presents completion relative to the present or as a bounded past event; pluperfect places completion before a past reference point; future perfect places it before a future point. Imperfect presents past action as ongoing, repeated, or incomplete. The Latin forms and proposed English must agree with those relations.

CHAPTER 3

Selected worksheet solutions

CHAPTER 4

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.33

Focus: Perfect stems, endings, and completed action

Use: Show the third principal part used for every irregular stem.

1. Derive perfect stems from *laudavi*, *monui*, *rexi*, *cepi*, *audivi*, *dixi*.
Answer / model: *laudav-*, *monu-*, *rex-*, *cep-*, *audiv-*, *dix-*.
2. Write all six perfect active indicative forms of *laudo*.
Answer / model: *laudavi*, *laudavisti*, *laudavit*, *laudavimus*, *laudavistis*, *laudaverunt*.
3. Give 1 singular, 2 plural, and 3 plural pluperfect and future perfect of *audio*.
Answer / model: Pluperfect: *audiveram*, *audiveratis*, *audiverant*. Future perfect: *audivero*, *audiveritis*, *audiverint*.
4. Contrast *laudabat* with *laudavit* in form and aspect.
Answer / model: *laudabat*: 3 singular imperfect active indicative, “was praising/used to praise”; *laudavit*: 3 singular perfect active indicative, “praised/has praised”. The former views action as ongoing or repeated, the latter as complete.
5. Correct *heri Deum laudabit*, intended “yesterday he praised God”.
Answer / model: *Heri Deum laudavit*. *Laudabit* is future; completed past requires perfect *laudavit*.
6. **Text:** *Resurrexit, sicut dixit*.
Passage ID: I.33.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
This is an excerpt of the traditional *Regina cæli* antiphon whose controlling edition remains unresolved; parse both verbs and translate.
Answer / notes: *resurrexit*: 3 singular perfect active indicative of *resurgo*, *resurgere*, *resurrexi*; *dixit*: 3 singular perfect active indicative of *dico*, *dicere*, *dixi*. “He has risen, as he said.”

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.36

Focus: Perfect versus imperfect and coordinated completed acts

Use: This variant is an independent mastery sample.

1. Write all persons of the pluperfect and future perfect of *rego* using perfect stem *rex-*.
Answer / model: Pluperfect: *rexeram*, *rexeras*, *rexerat*, *rexeramus*, *rexeratis*, *rexerant*. Future perfect: *rexero*, *rexeris*, *rexerit*, *rexerimus*, *rexeritis*, *rexerint*.
2. Classify and translate *creabat*, *creavit*, *creaverat*, *creaverit*.
Answer / model: 3 singular imperfect “was creating”; 3 singular perfect “created/has created”; 3 singular pluperfect “had created”; 3 singular future perfect “will have created”.
3. Give the alternative third-person plural perfect ending and form it from *laudav-*; state the preferred production form.
Answer / model: Alternative ending *-ere*: *laudavere*. Preferred production form: *laudaverunt*.
4. Translate “he said”, “we had done”, “they have come”, and “I shall have heard”.
Answer / model: *dixit*; *feceramus*; *venerunt*; *audivero*.
5. Diagnose *heri videbamus aquam et vidimus templum* if both acts are presented as single completed events.
Answer / model: *Heri vidimus aquam et vidimus templum*. Imperfect *videbamus* would present the first seeing as ongoing/repeated; perfect presents both as completed.
6. **Text:** *Deposuit potentes de sede, et exaltavit humiles*.
Passage ID: I.36.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse verbs and substantival adjectives; identify the governed phrase and translate.
Answer / notes: *deposuit*, *exaltavit*: 3 singular perfect active indicative with understood divine subject. *potentes*, *humiles*: masculine/feminine plural accusative substantival adjectives, direct objects. *de sede*: ablative after *de*. “He has put down the mighty from their seat and exalted the lowly.”

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.9, *The Perfect Active System*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. This packet teaches active perfect-system morphology and basic aspectual contrast; later contexts may require more nuanced English tense choices.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source

roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T21:32:44Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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